



PARISH NEWSLETTER

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Fr Micheál McGavigan PP – Fr Roni Zacharias CC – Fr Stephen Ward CC

Sunday 23rd August 2026 – Twenty First Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A

In this Sunday's Gospel, Jesus asks his disciples a question that reaches across the centuries and speaks to every Christian: "Who do you say I am?" The disciples can easily repeat what others are saying, but Jesus invites them to move beyond public opinion to a personal profession of faith. Peter responds, "You are the Christ, the Son of the living God," not because he has learned the right answer, but because he has come to know Jesus through walking alongside him. In a world filled with competing voices and opinions, the Lord still asks each of us the same question. Faith cannot rely solely on what others believe or what we learned long ago. It grows through our own experience of Christ's presence in our lives, especially in moments of joy, struggle, loss and hope. As we reflect on the Gospel this week, may we recognise anew the Lord who walks with us and find in him the firm foundation on which to build our lives.

WELCOME TO GOD'S FAMILY

Kayleigh Rose Devine; Hannah Mary Lau; Lorcan Gabriel McIvor; Emily Claire Martin.

REQUIESCANT IN PACE

We offer our sympathies to the family and friends of:

Helen Bradley, Lenamore Gardens; Frances (Lily) Friel, Castlevue Park; Elizabeth Rankin, Pennyburn Court; Anne Campbell, Aberfoyle Crescent; Noel Rodgers, Bloomfield Park

ANNIVERSARIES

Anna Marie Stewart; Kathleen Downey; Micky Doherty; Margaret Yates; Kevin Leonard; Pearse Donnelly; Henry Bryson; Rosaleen Barnett; Eileen Johnson; James & Jean McCauley; Margaret McCarron; Bosco Heaney; Annie Barnfield; Barney Quigg; Bridget Elliott; Davy McLaughlin; Bronagh Sharkey; Gerry Sharkey; Greg Sharkey; Eugene Crawford; Tom Stokes; Jimmy Crumley.

READINGS FOR SUNDAY 23rd AUGUST

1st Isaiah 22:10-23. Psalm: 137:1-3, 6, 8, R/v8.

2nd Romans 11:33-36.

Gospel Matthew 16:13-20

SIMPLE FAMILY PRAYER BOOK

This Sunday begins psalter week 1

READERS NEEDED AT MASS

Our parish is seeking new readers to proclaim the Word of God at weekend Masses. This is a valuable ministry that helps bring the Scriptures to life for our congregation. No previous experience is necessary, and full training and support will be provided. If you would be willing to serve in this important role, or would like to find out more, please contact the parish office or speak to one of the priests after Mass.

VOCATIONS

In this Sunday's gospel Peter acknowledges Jesus as the Christ, the Son of the living God, and Jesus confers on Peter "...the keys of the Kingdom..." an image reflected in the First Reading where the Lord says He will "...place the key of David..." on the shoulder of those called to lead His people, those who will be called "father."

BUNCRANA PARISH GARDEN FETE 2026

The Annual Garden Fete will take place today, Sunday, 23 August, from 3.00 - 6.00pm in the grounds of Scoil Mhuire, Bunrana F93 PN53. Fun for all the family with Bouncy Castles, Mechanical Bull, Petting Farm, Facepainting, Bingo, Rickety Wheel, Children's Games, Raffle Prizes and more. Entry €5pp or €15 per family (cash only). All welcome.

LAST WEEK'S OFFERTORY COLLECTION

St Patrick's Church: £1,266 - St Brigid's Church: £2,272 - St Joseph's Church: £910

2nd Collection (Maintenance & Pastoral Outreach): £1,082.

Thank you for your continued generosity.

BANK DETAILS FOR ONLINE DONATIONS: A/C Name: The Parish of the Three Patrons

Sort Code: 95-06-79 A/C No: 60320021

EMBRACE THE GRACE

Young Adult Catholic Conference - 29 August 2026 - a conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion of Mary headquarters at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. It will be a chance to build faith in friendship with young adults from across the country. Saturday 30 August from 9.30am to 6pm with a social afterwards. Tickets €20 and can be booked on the eventbrite website by looking up 'Embrace the Grace'. Further queries contact: deusetpatria@gmail.com

BLESSING OF BIKERS & MOTORCYCLES

Will take place on Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1:30. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI. Please note, Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13 September in St Patrick's Chapel, Dungiven, at 11:30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in past year.

MICHAEL ENGLISH CHURCH CONCERT

An evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration. The concert takes place on Friday 2 October at 7.15pm, in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets are £30, and available to buy at Herons Gift Shop, Draperstown, Moneyneena Post Office, Ballinascreen and Desertmartin Parish offices, or online with Eventbrite: <https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/michael-english-band-fundraising-concert-tickets-1996641829460>

MARRIAGE ENRICHMENT WEEKEND

Marriage Encounter Ireland invites married couples to a residential Weekend from Friday 2 to Sunday 4 October 2026 at the Focolare Centre, Curryhills, Prosperous, Co. Kildare. Step away from daily distractions to deepen your communication, renew your love, and rediscover the joy of your marriage. Visit www.marriageencounter.ie

ST PIO CAFÉ

The Café at St Pio house will be closed for the next few weeks and will reopen on Tuesday 2nd September. We thank all those who help to make this such a success.

CATHOLIC MOTHERS IRELAND – FAMILY DAY

Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on Sunday 6 September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry. The day will begin with Mass at 2.00pm, celebrated by Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. For more information and booking details, please email info@catholicmothers.ie. All are welcome.

PRIVACY NOTICE

The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations, and a privacy notice is available on the Parish website or by contacting the Parish Office. Livestream and recordings of Mass and services in our Churches are available online. Please note that the front rows of seats are visible online.

SAFEGUARDING

If you have any concerns about the Safeguarding of Children or vulnerable adults within the Church, please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596500793 or at dlp@derrydiocese.org

PARISH GROUPS & MEETINGS (SUMMER)

Monday	After 11am Mass 1pm – 2.30pm 7pm - 9pm	Holy Souls Prayer Group Legion of Mary Woman's Craft Group	Our Lady's Chapel, Galliagh Meeting Room, St Joseph's Church, Galliagh Kildare Room, Carnhill
Tuesday	After 11am Mass 11.30am - 2.30pm 7.30pm - 9.30pm	Devotion to the Holy Face St. Pio's Café Living Disciples Prayer Group	Our Lady's Chapel, Galliagh St Pio Centre, Galliagh (Closed until September) St Pio Centre, Galliagh
Thursday	11.30am - 2.30pm 6pm – 7pm 7pm – 8pm 7.30pm - 8.30pm 8.15pm – 10pm	St. Pio's Café Divine Will Prayer Group Holy Hour for the Unborn Youth Prayer Group Be Still – Men's Prayer Group	St. Pio Centre, Galliagh (Closed until September) Kildare Room, Carnhill Our Lady's Chapel St. Pio Centre, Galliagh Our Lady's Chapel
Friday	11.30am-12.30pm	Divine Mercy Prayer Group	Our Lady's Chapel, Galliagh

PARISH SCHEDULE - SUMMER ST PATRICK'S CHURCH, PENNYBURN

Sunday Mass:	Vigil 6.15pm; 9.45am
Weekday Mass:	Monday to Friday: 10am
Confessions:	Saturday: 5.15pm – 6pm
Baptisms:	Saturday: 4.30pm; Sunday: 1.30pm

ST BRIGID'S CHURCH, CARNHILL

Sunday Mass:	Vigil 5pm; 10.30am & 12.30pm
Weekday Mass:	Monday to Friday: 9.30am; Saturday: 11am
Confessions:	Saturday after 11.00am Mass and 4pm - 4.45pm
Eucharistic Adoration:	Daily: 8.00am – 8.00pm in St Carlo Acutis Chapel
Baptisms:	Saturday: 3.30pm

ST JOSEPH'S CHURCH, GALLIAGH

Sunday Mass:	11.00am; 12.30pm (<i>An tAifreann Naofa</i>); 6.30pm
Weekday Mass:	Monday to Friday: 11am
Confessions:	Sunday: 5.30pm – 6.15pm
Eucharistic Adoration:	Tuesday: 11.30am – 1pm in Our Lady's Chapel
Baptisms:	Saturday: 3.30pm